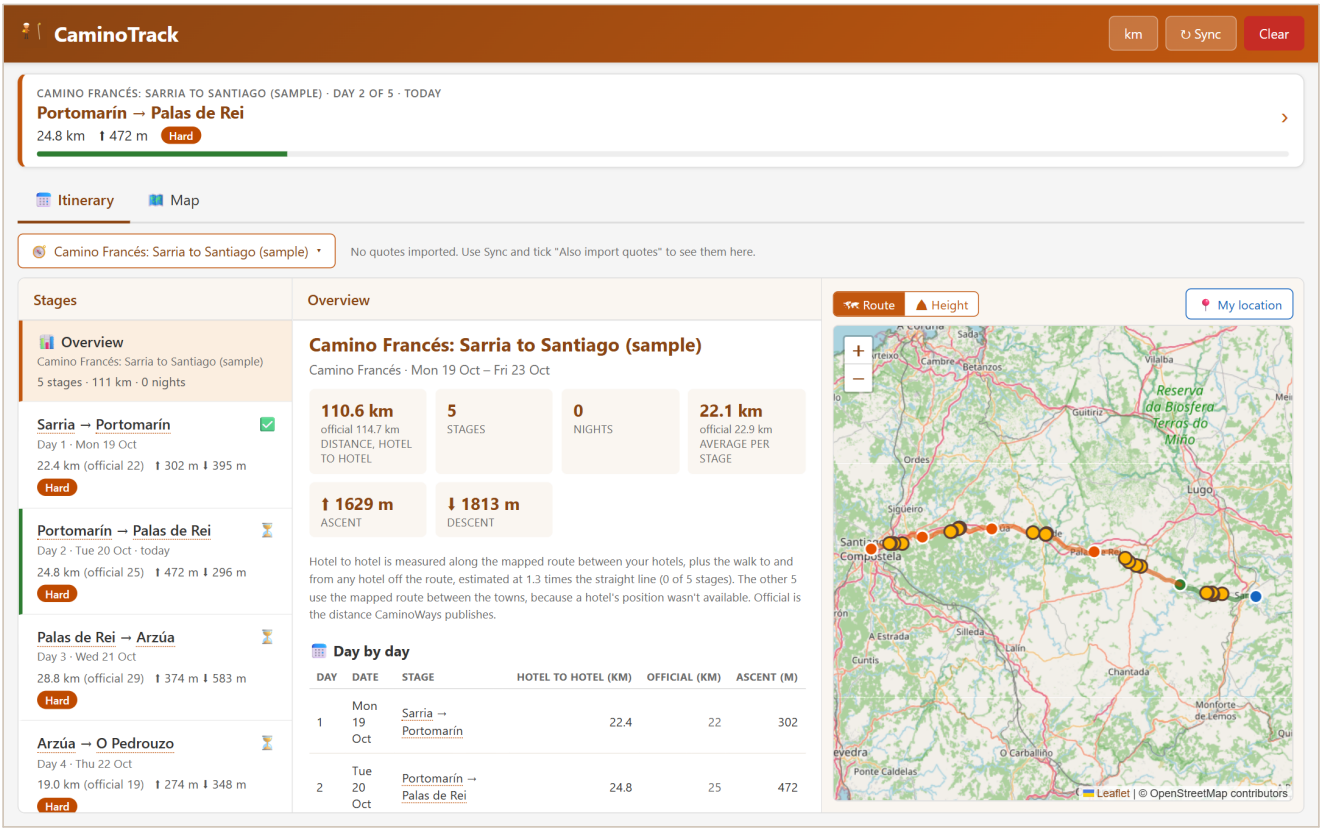
CaminoTrack

Your CaminoWays itinerary, turned into a day-by-day walking companion for phone, iPad and desktop.

CaminoTrack takes a walker's CaminoWays booking and shows each walking day the way a walker actually needs it: how far it really is from hotel to hotel, how much climbing there is, which villages are passed, where the food and water stops are, and where the long stretches with nothing are. On the trail it shows a live map, tells the walker how far they have come and how far is left, and works with no signal at all.

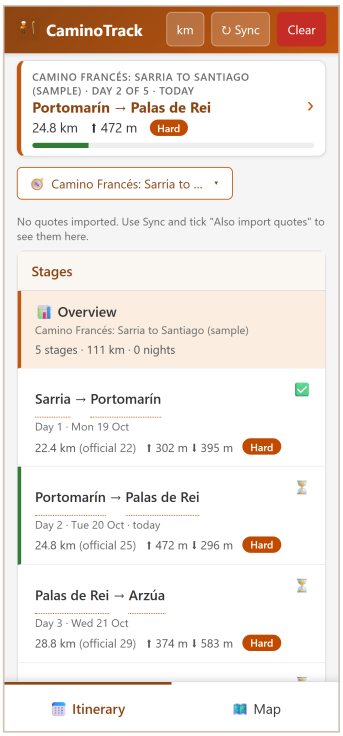
The three screens below are the same app on a phone, an iPad and a desktop browser. The layout adapts: a bottom tab bar on the phone, and a stage list, day detail and map side by side on a wide screen.



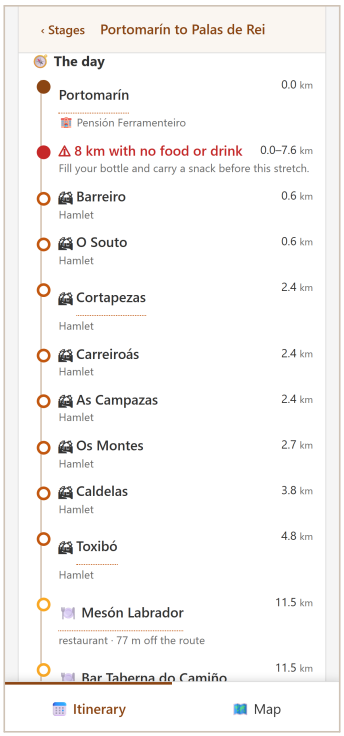
Desktop: the Today strip, the trip's stages, the trip overview and the route map.

On the phone

Most walkers will use CaminoTrack on a phone, so that is the primary design. The app can be added to the home screen and opens like any other app, with no app-store download.



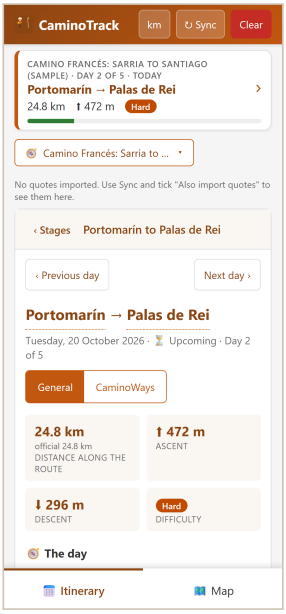
Today at a glance. *The strip at the top always shows where the walker is in the trip and opens today's stage.*



The day as a timeline. *Villages, places to eat and the longest stretch without food, with the distance to each.*



Tap any town *for a short description, a photo and nearby sights (from Wikipedia).*



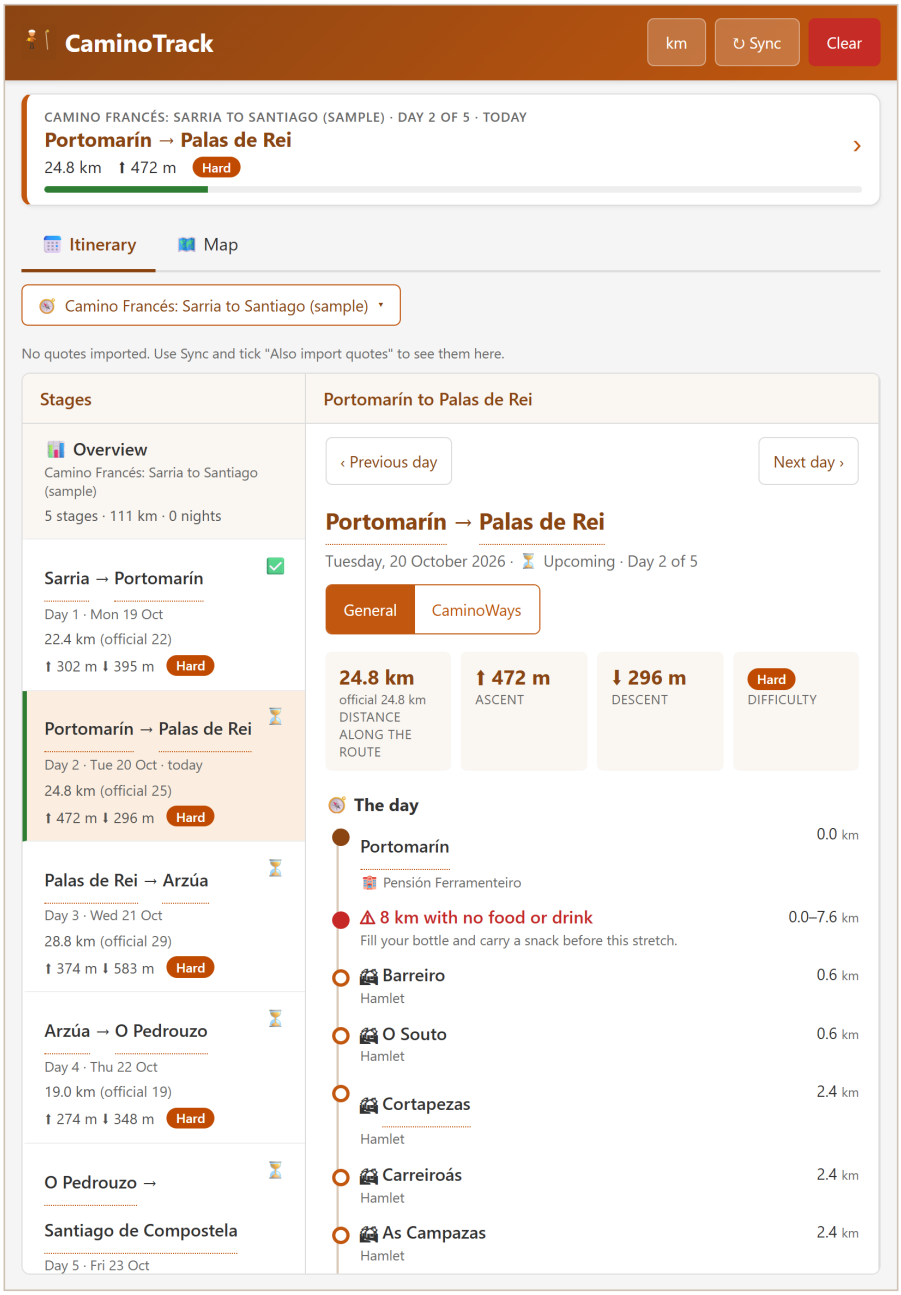
Stage summary. *Hotel-to-hotel distance, ascent, descent and a difficulty rating, with previous and next day buttons.*



Map. *The stage on the map, with the villages passed. Press Start walking to follow your position.*

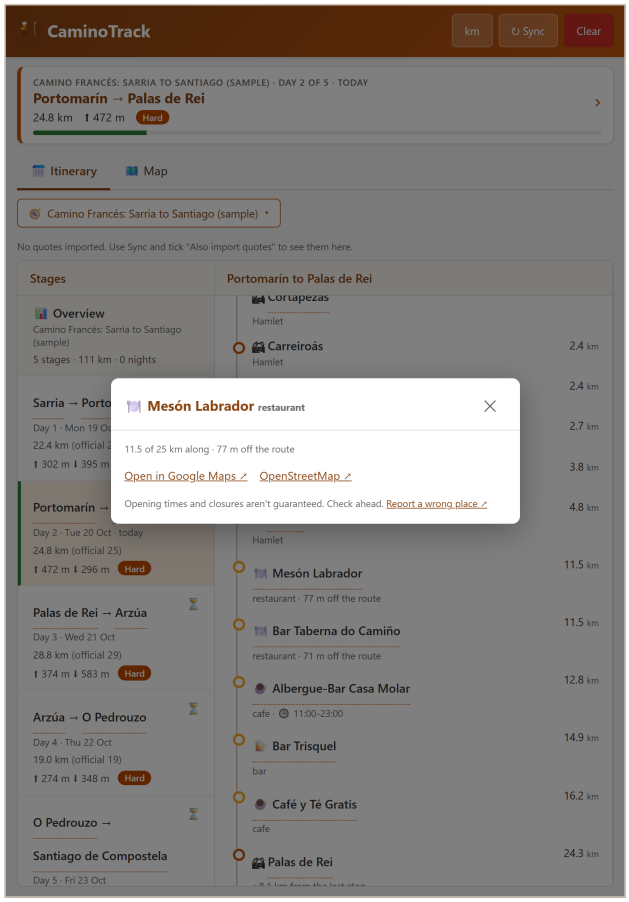
On the iPad

On a tablet the stage list and the day's detail sit side by side, so the walker can flip between days quickly when planning the evening before. Tapping a place to eat shows how far along the stage it is and how far off the route.

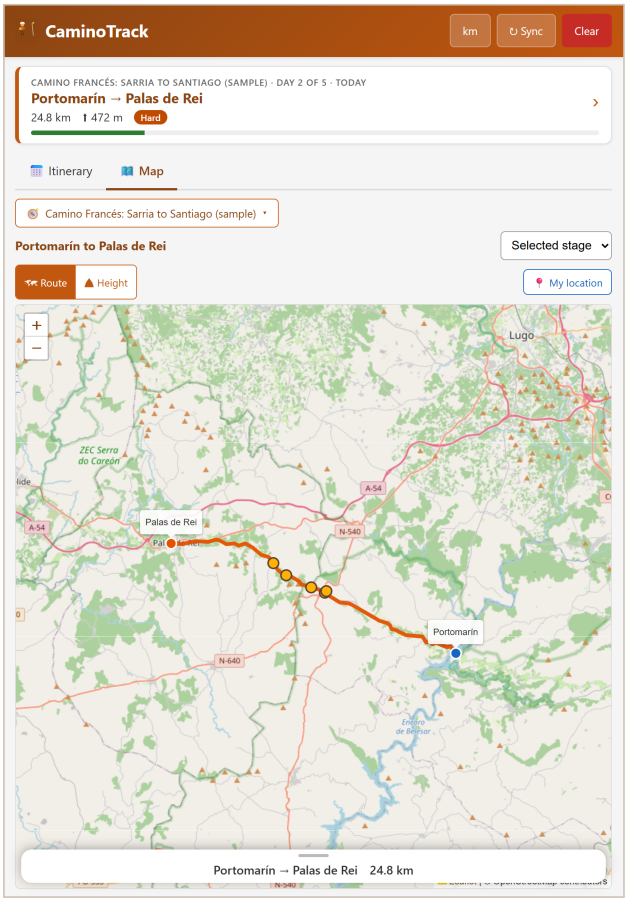


iPad, portrait: stage list on the left and the detail for Portomarín to Palas de Rei on the right.

On the iPad: places to eat and the map



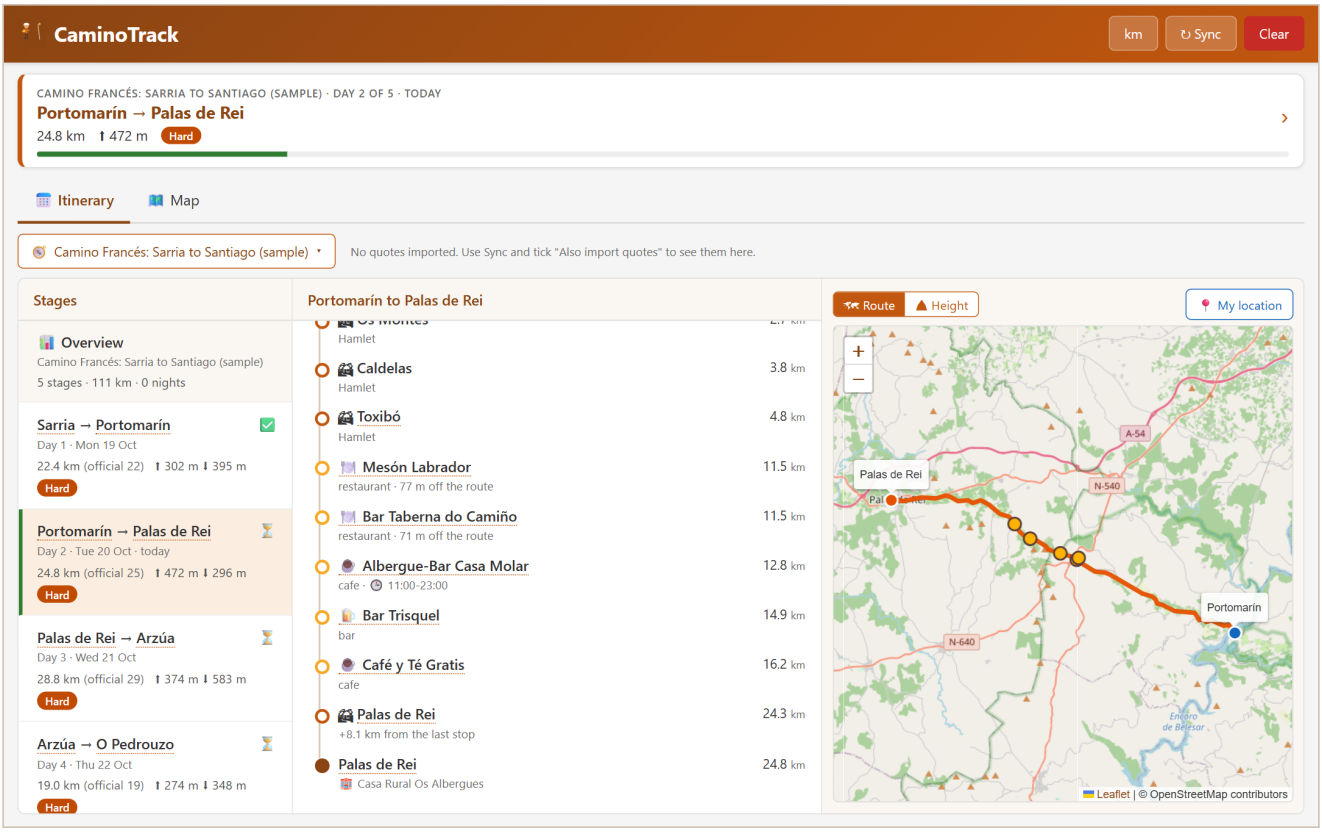
Tapping a place to eat shows how far along the stage it is, how far off the route, and links to Google Maps and OpenStreetMap.



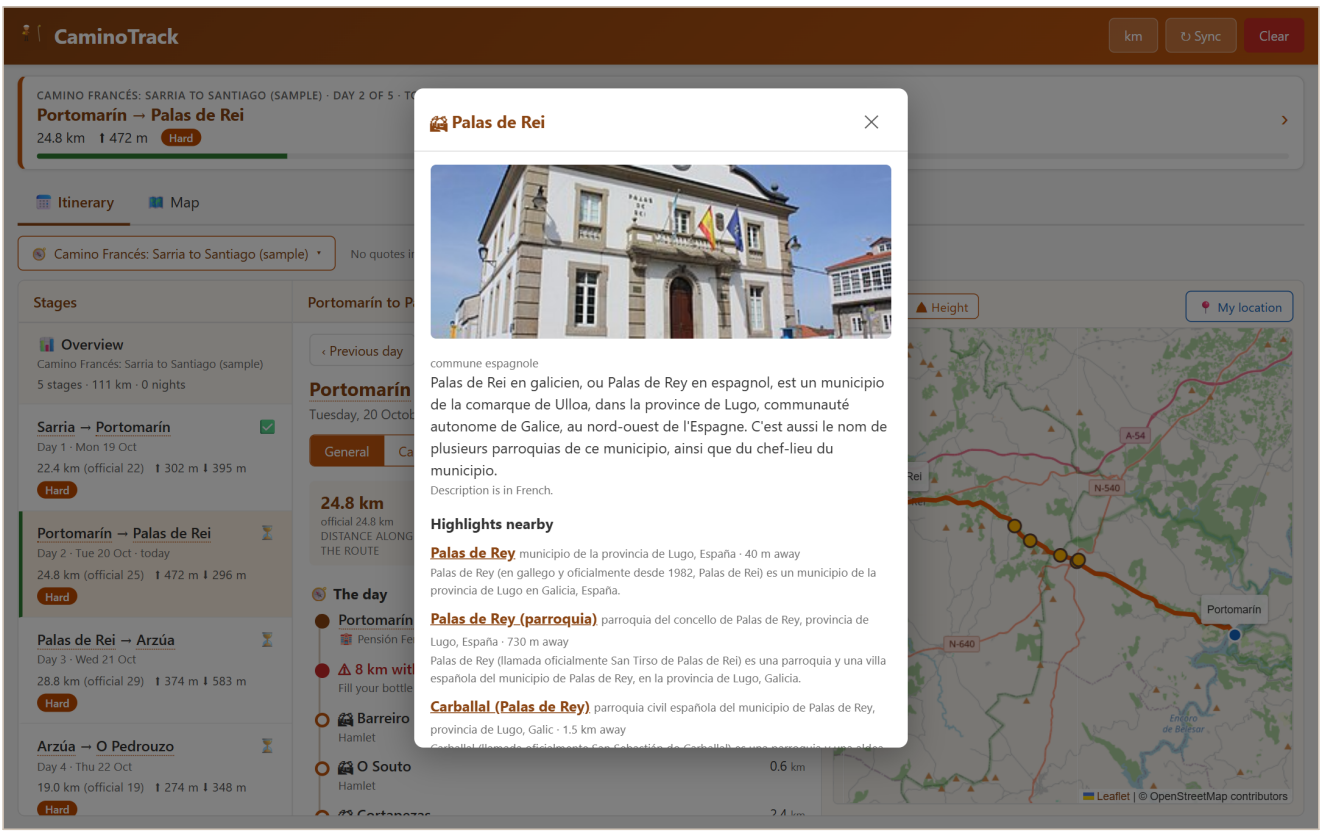
The map of the selected stage, with the route, the villages and the start and end.

On the desktop

On a wide screen everything is visible at once: the stages, the detail for the selected day and the map. This suits planning, and checking a whole trip before departure.



The day's timeline with the route map beside it.



A town's description and nearby highlights open over the page.

What the app does

Your itinerary, with the real figures

- **Sync** reads the walker's own CaminoWays bookings and turns each trip into one stage per walking day, with dates, hotels and the CaminoWays distances. Quotes can be imported too.
- **Hotel-to-hotel distance** is measured along the mapped route between the two hotels, plus the walk to and from any hotel off the route. The published CaminoWays distance is shown beside it.
- **Ascent, descent and difficulty** for each day, from open elevation data. Difficulty compares the day with every stretch of the same length on that route, and with the rest of the trip.
- **Trip overview** with total distance, climb, nights and a day-by-day table; a drop-down switches between trips.
- **CaminoWays tab** on each day keeps what CaminoWays itself says about it (hotels, inclusions, service level).

Along the way

- **Villages and towns passed**, in walking order with the distance to each. Hamlets appear only where a stage passes few other places.
- **Places to eat and drink** from OpenStreetMap, with opening hours where known, and a clear warning when there is a long stretch with no food or water.
- **Town descriptions and nearby sights** from Wikipedia. Only places that have an article are tappable, so the app never opens an empty page.

On the trail

- **Walking mode.** Press Start walking and the map follows the walker, shows distance done and left, the next village, and warns if they leave the route. The screen stays on while following.
- **Works offline.** A stage's town descriptions can be saved before leaving a hotel with wifi, and the app keeps working with no signal.
- **km or miles** at the touch of a button, and a Today strip that opens the current day.

Privacy and cost

- Nothing is stored on a server. The CaminoWays login is used for the one sync request and is never stored or logged. The stages are kept in the walker's own browser.
- Route data comes from public sources: OpenStreetMap, open elevation data and Wikipedia. There is no account to create and nothing to install.

Coverage and how it is built

Routes built so far

- **Camino Francés**, Saint-Jean-Pied-de-Port to Santiago, with 533 villages and hamlets on the route.
- **Via Francigena in Tuscany**, Lucca to Siena, with 72 villages and hamlets on the route.
- Town descriptions are stored for the 284 of those 605 places that have a Wikipedia article. A trip on a route that has not been built is still shown from the CaminoWays data, without route figures.

How it is built

- A small Python (FastAPI) web service with a plain JavaScript front end and a Leaflet map. It runs on Google Cloud Run and scales to zero when idle.
- It can run on any host that runs a web service.

Possible next steps

- More routes, built the same way as the two above.
- Google ratings and reviews on places to eat. This is an optional feature that needs a Google key.

Screenshots in this document use a sample five-day trip, Sarria to Santiago, created for illustration. They do not show a real booking. Distances, climbs and places are calculated by the app from the mapped route.